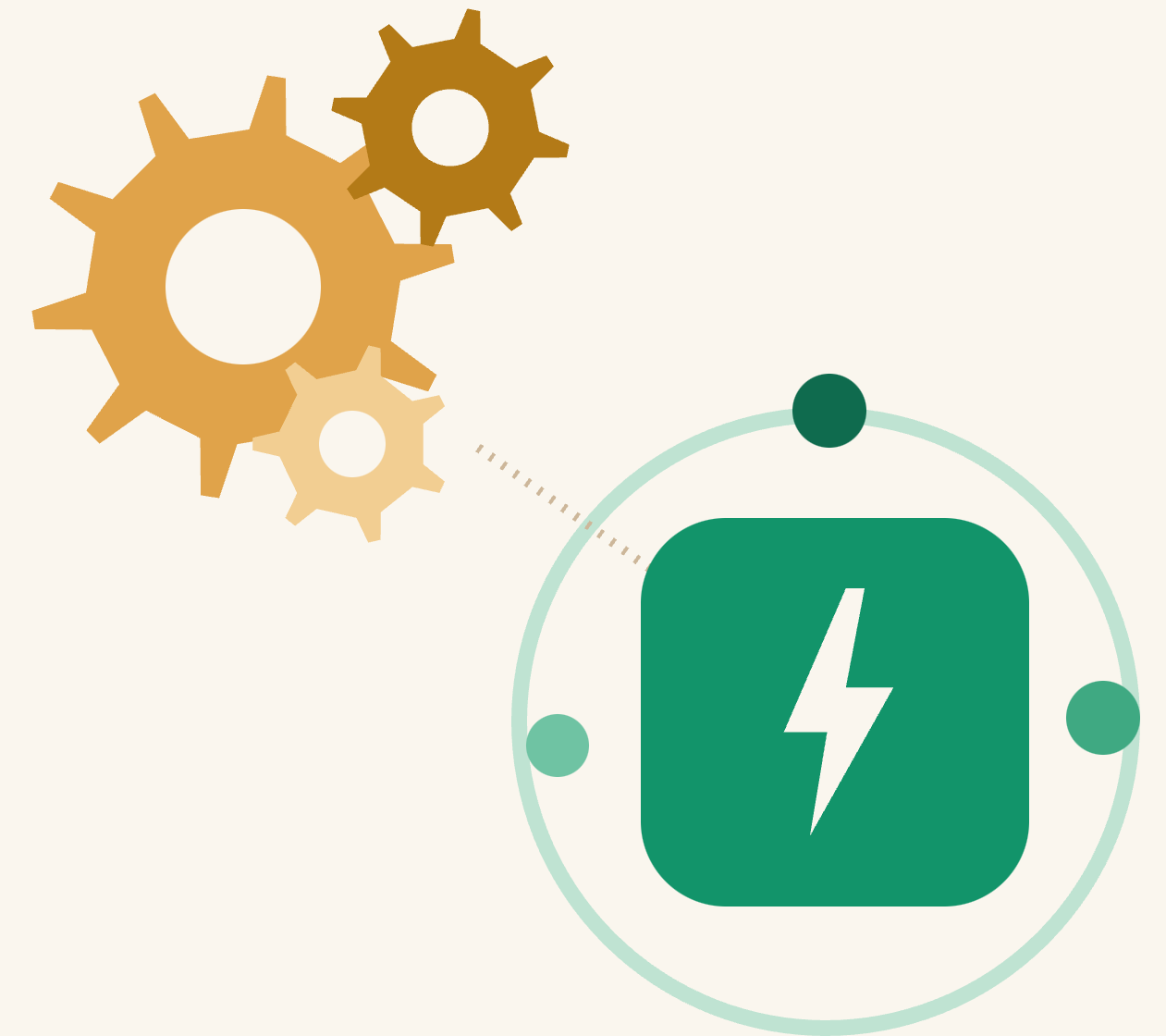


Automation or Agentic AI?

You don't have to choose.

What I learned building with both — and a simple way for you to start today.



First, I taught machines to repeat me.

Power Automate — running in the cloud, 24 / 7.

1 Repetitive by design

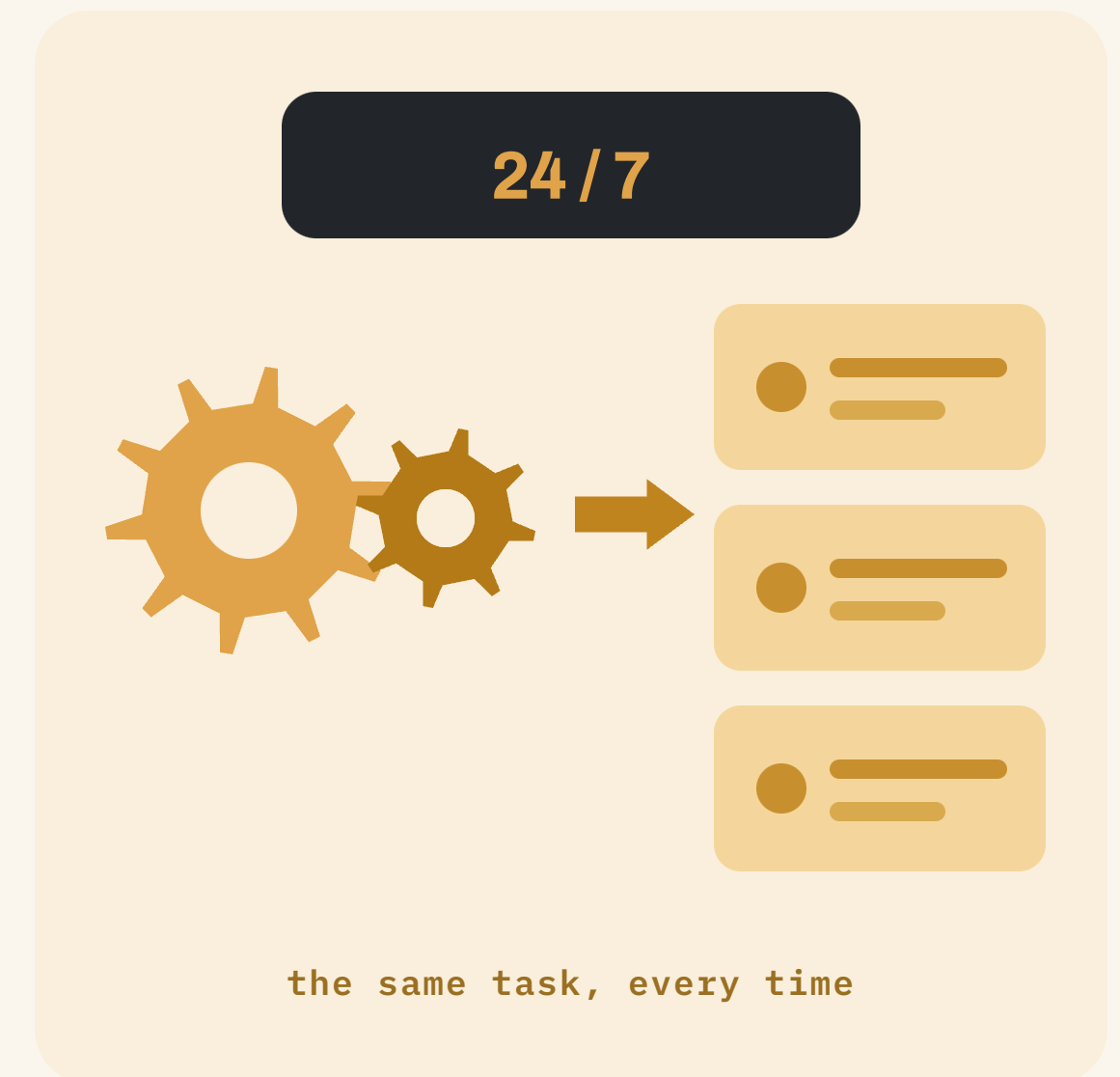
The same task, the same way, every single time — no drift, no forgetting.

2 Reliable & tireless

It never sleeps, takes breaks, or loses focus at 2 a.m.

3 Your easiest entry point

If your day is full of copy-paste chores, this is where you begin.



The real skill is workflow thinking.

Break down the human. Rebuild it as a machine.

1

Map every human step

Watch how a person really does the task — click by click, decision by decision.

2

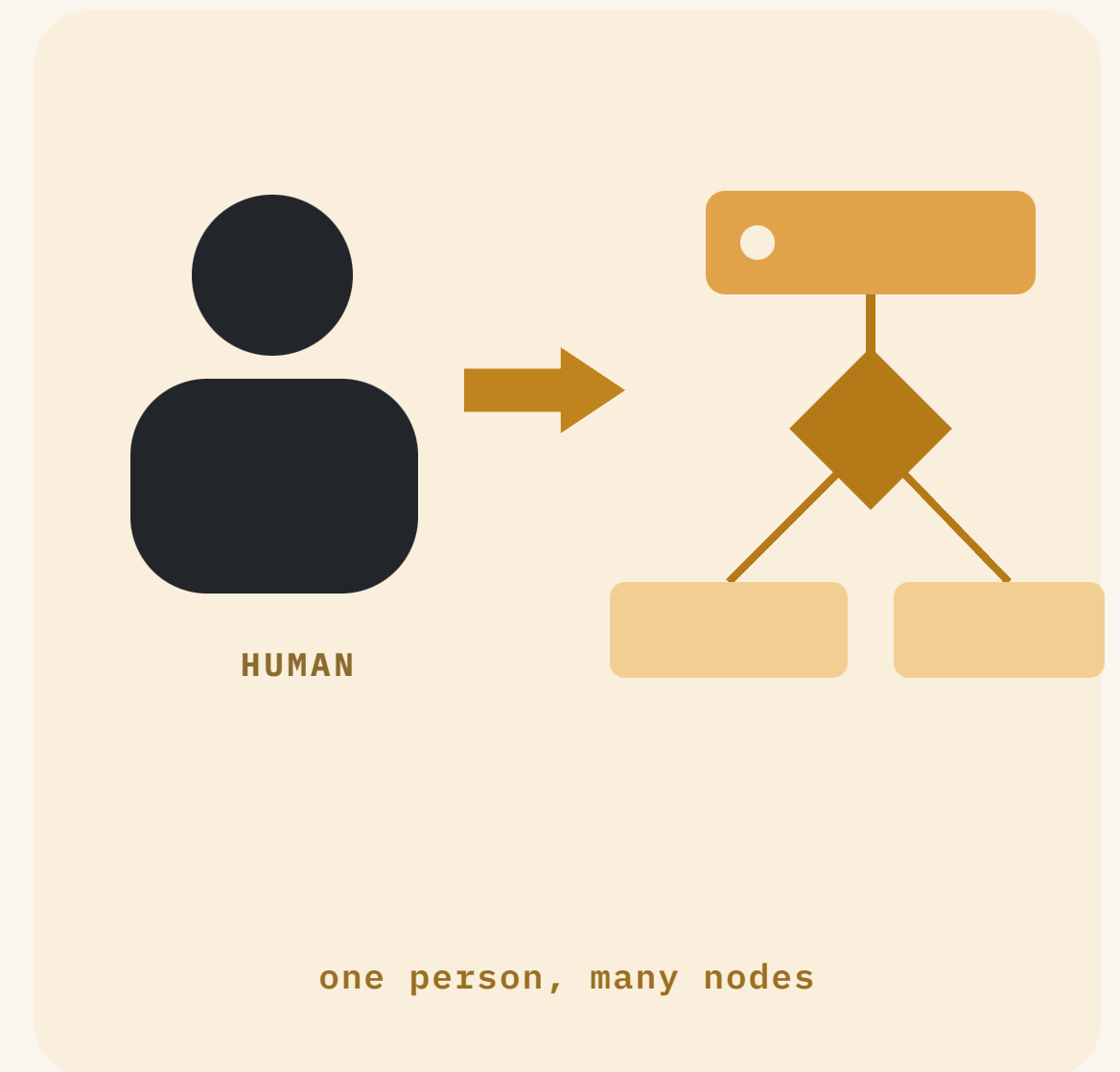
Translate it into nodes

One human step can become several nodes — inputs, routes and conditions, made explicit.

3

It transfers everywhere

Think this way once and it carries over — including to how you brief an AI.



You define every little detail.

Precision is powerful — and it's a lot of work.

1

Everything is manual

Every input, route and error path, mapped by hand — like plumbing a whole building.

2

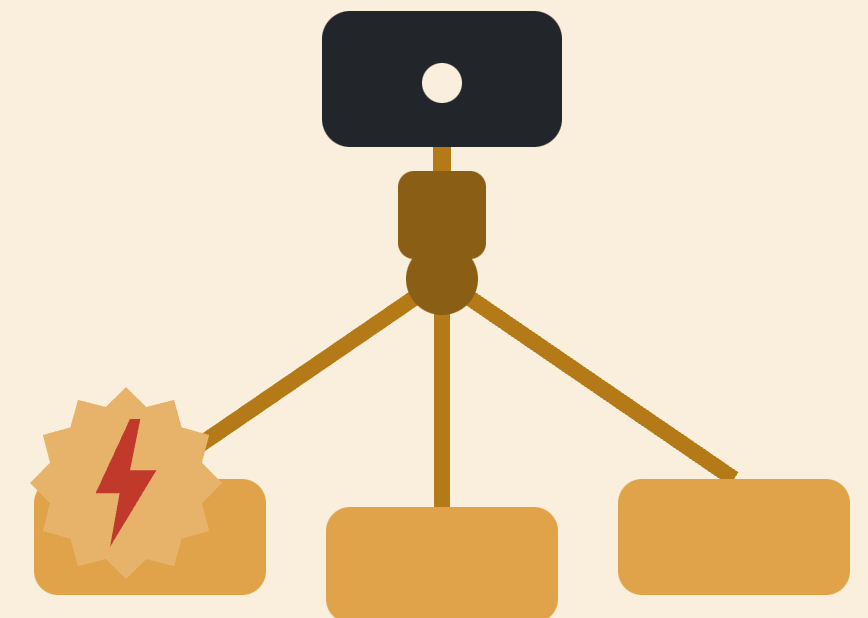
Brittle at the edges

Change one tool or format and the pipe can break somewhere downstream.

3

It still needs you

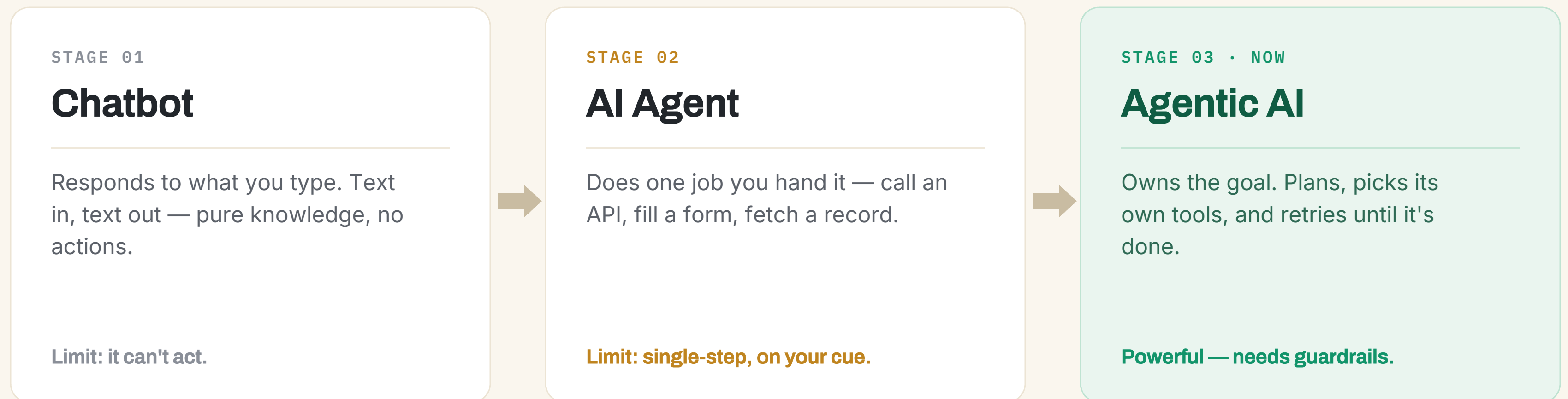
It runs on its own, but you monitor it to catch what quietly slips.



one change can break the chain

Chatbot. Agent. Agentic AI.

The three words everyone uses — and what they actually mean.



Give it a goal. It works out the rest.

Now my personal work runs on agentic harnesses.

1

It plans and picks tools

Describe the outcome; it chooses the tools and sets the arguments itself.

2

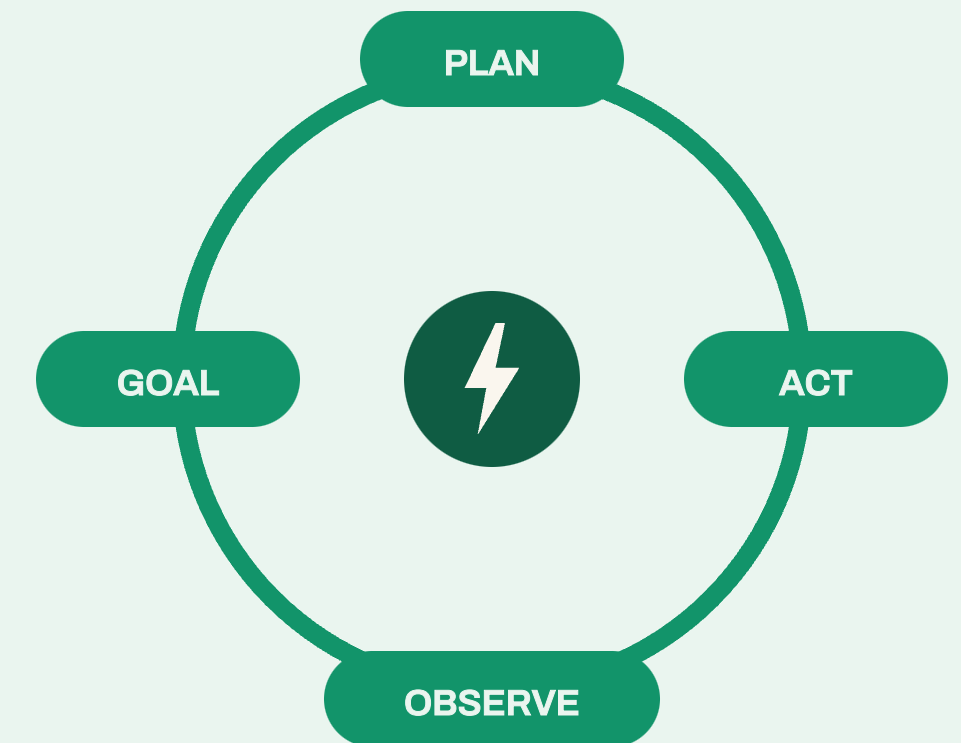
It adapts and retries

Hits an error, reads it, tries another route — no pre-scripted path.

3

It understands context

It reads the meaning in your data, not just the fields. Automation can't.



plan → act → observe → repeat

When to reach for which.

Two tools, two jobs — here's the cheat sheet.

	AUTOMATION	AGENTIC AI
Best for	Repetitive, known work	Novel, ambiguous work
Designed by	You, in advance	It, per task
Speed & cost	Fast, cheap, consistent	Slower, more costly
Reliability	Deterministic, exact	Flexible, guardrailed
Reaches tools via	Connectors	MCP (tool protocol)

So — which one do you need?

Four questions. Ask them about your own task.

Same every time, or different?

Same → Automate

Different → Agent

Can you script every step upfront?

Yes → Automate

No → Agent

Is the input structured, or messy?

Structured → Automate

Messy → Agent

Cheap at scale, or smart one-off?

Scale → Automate

Smart → Agent

If you can define it → automate it. If it needs to think → hand it to an agent.

From tools to teammates.

The frontier: agents that work like a team.

1

Orchestration

Several agents split a job, hand off, and check each other — like people do.

2

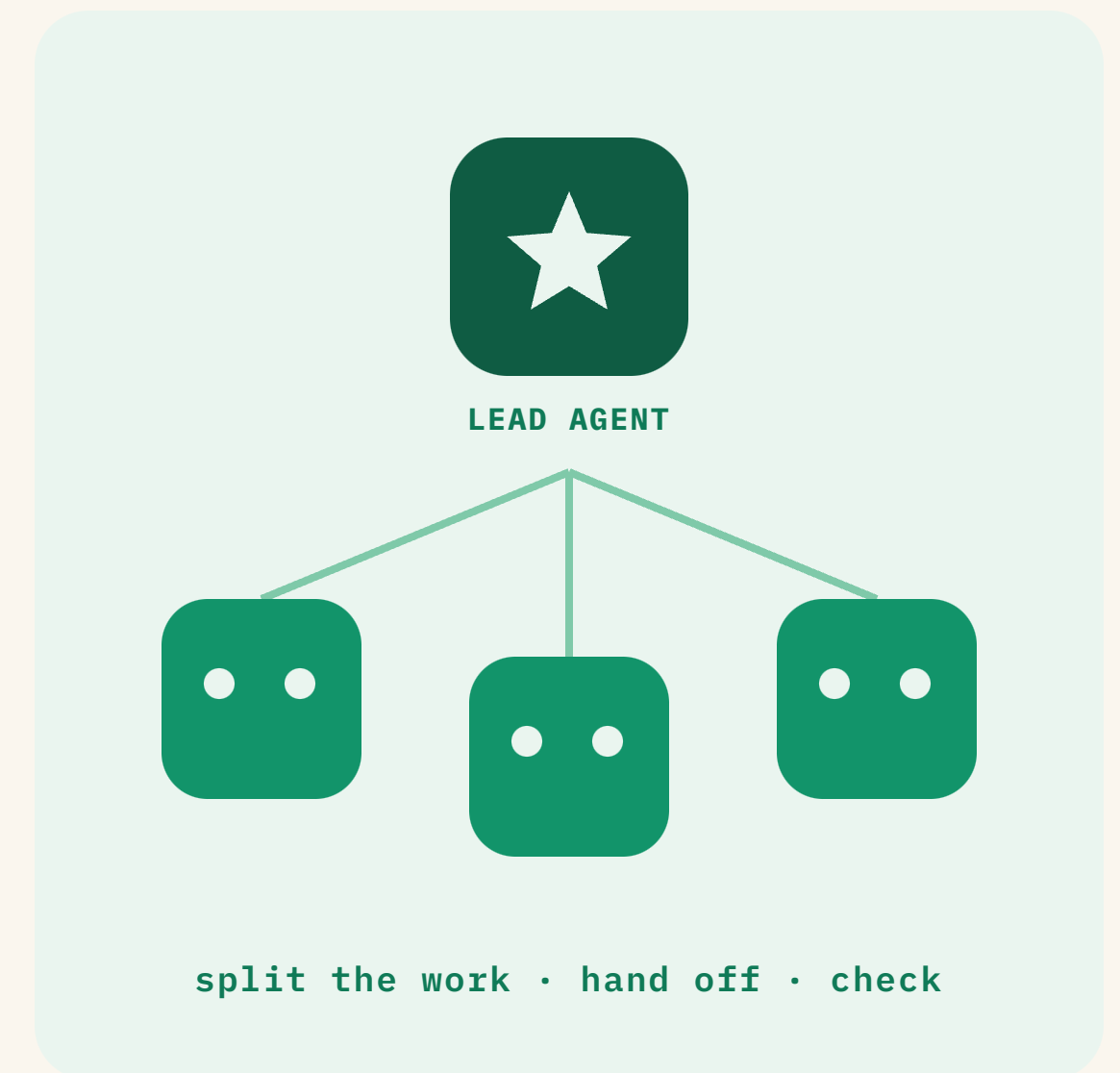
Grounded, not guessing

Real tool-use (MCP) replaces agents just talking — so they hallucinate less.

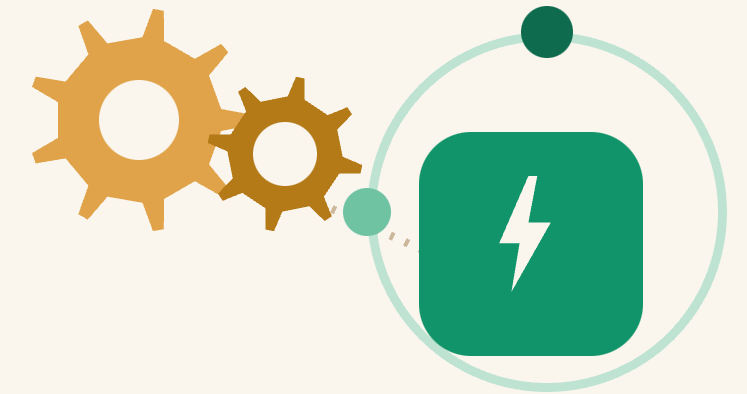
3

They meet automation

Agents will trigger your automations; automations will call agents.



You don't need to master both. Just start.



THE EASY ONE

Automate one boring task

Pick one repetitive chore this week and wire it up in Power Automate.

THE BOLD ONE

Hand one mess to an agent

Take one fuzzy problem and let an agentic tool figure it out.

Both compound. The only wrong move is not starting.